

Cubs Practice — Coaches Quick Sheet

Tuesday, Sept. 15 | 6:30–8:00 PM | Davis Park Field 1

Focus: Hitting Fundamentals • Defensive Reps • Baseball IQ

6:30–6:40 — Warm-Up + Partner Throwing

Dynamic warm-up → partner throwing → finish with short ground-ball exchanges.

Focus: Good footwork, step toward target, accurate throws.

6:40–7:40 — 3 Stations × 20 Minutes

Station	Location	What We're Doing
1 — Tee / Contact	Side of field / net	Proper setup, balance, contact point, barrel through ball
2 — Live Hitting + Infield	Main Diamond	Coach pitch from ~40 ft; hitters get live ABs while IF plays every ball
3 — Outfield Fundamentals	Deep OF / cones	Ground balls, get behind ball, crow hop, strong throws to cutoff

Rotate groups every 20 minutes. No station overlap.

Station 1 — Tee / Contact

This is **instructional**, not just hitting balls off a tee.

- Ball slightly in front of hitter
- Balanced stance and load
- Eyes on ball through contact
- Square up the baseball — **contact before power**
- Finish balanced
- Correct **one thing at a time**

Station 2 — Live Hitting + Infield

6 pitches max per hitter. Throw strikes.

Fielders rotate through **P / 1B / 2B / SS / 3B**.

Every ball is live: **Field → Set Feet → Make the Out.**

Before some pitches, call the situation: *“Runner on first!” “Runner on second!” “Where's your play?”*

Hitting focus: Take the tee mechanics into a live AB.

Defense focus: Know where the ball is going **before it's hit**.

Station 3 — Outfield Fundamentals

Use cones/bases well into the outfield and **away from Station 2's hitting area**.

Ground ball → get behind it → field cleanly → crow hop → strong throw.

Mix in:

- Balls left/right
- Charging slow rollers
- Throwing to a cutoff
- **Get the ball back in quickly!**

7:40–7:55 — Situational Scrimmage

Use the full field. Coach pitch, **6-pitch max ABs**.

Normal baserunning + live defense. Before selected ABs, give the defense a situation and make players communicate where the play is.

Keep it moving — reps > instruction here.

7:55–8:00 — Team Huddle

Respect & Effort. Recognize 1–2 examples of good effort/improvement.

BIG COACHING POINT: These are 8U players. Don't fix five things at once. **One correction → another rep → reinforce success.**